Sinima

DRAFT 2 · STRUCTURE APPROVED, FORMAT JOURNEY ADDED

Sitemap and user journey

How the app is put together and how someone moves through it, from opening Sinima to booking on the cinema's own site. Nothing here is built yet. It is here so we agree on the structure before any screen is designed.



Prepared for	Date	Covers	Pages
Chime	11 November 2026	Structure and flow only. No visual design.	10

Start from the cinema, not from a list of times

What you asked for, as I understand it: you open Sinima and see the cinemas near you. You pick one and see what it is showing, as posters, by day. You tap a time and book on that cinema's own site.

Before · what is live now

One long list of times

- Home is a single column of showings sorted by start time.
- Your area hides behind a button that opens a list.
- One showing per row, on desktop too. Posters are empty boxes.
- No way to start from a cinema you already like.

After · this proposal

Cinemas first, films as posters, three ways in

- Home shows cinemas, nearest your area first. Your area is on the page, not in a dropdown.
- A cinema's films are poster cards in a grid: several per row on desktop, two per row on a phone.
- Every film has artwork. No empty boxes.
- Two other ways in for people who think differently: by film, or by what starts soon.

1

Cinemas

"I go to Filmhouse Lekki. What's on?" The default. Pick a cinema, see its films by day.

2

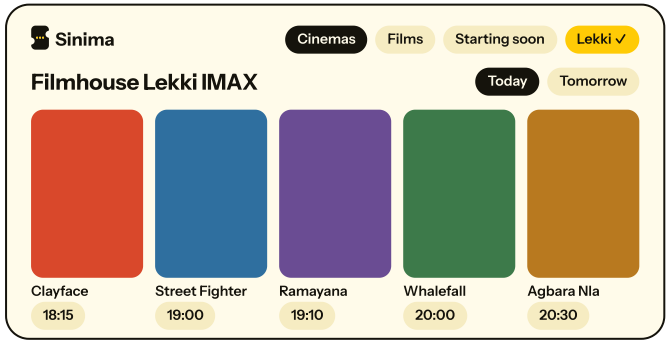
Films

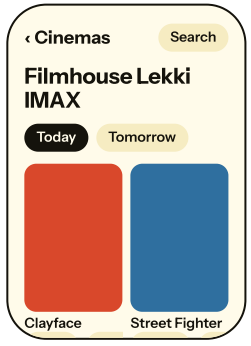
"I want to see Clayface. Where and when?" Pick a film, see every cinema showing it.

3

Starting soon

"I'm free now. What can I catch?" Films starting in the next 2 hours near you.



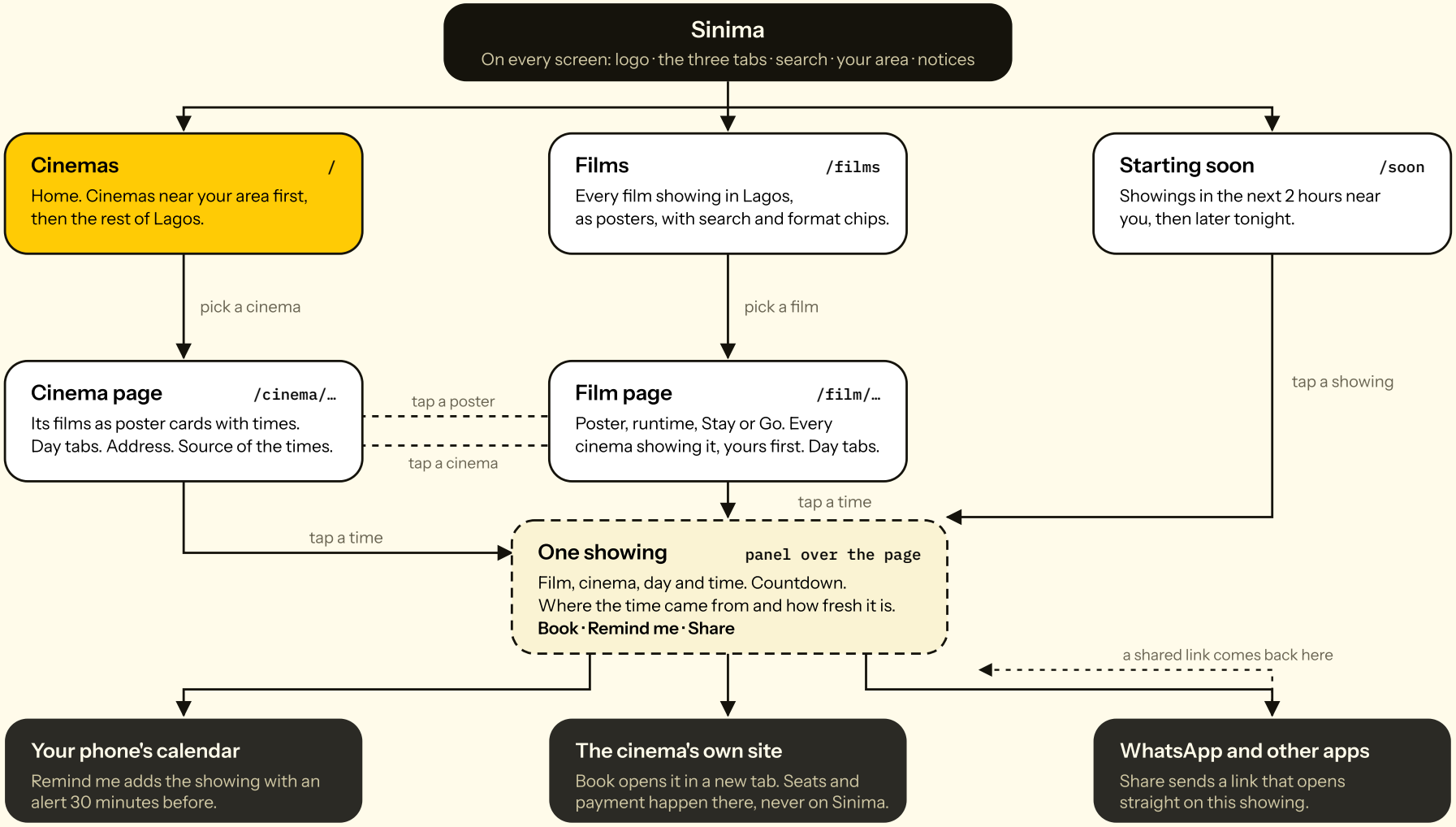


A diagram, not a design

Several posters per row, lined up

A cinema's page on a desktop and on a phone. The number per row follows the width of the screen: as many as line up cleanly on a desktop, two on a phone. All three ways in end at one showing, with a Book button that opens the cinema's own site.

Every screen, and how they connect



Where you land · A page · A panel over the page · Outside Sinima

Also: **About** (/about), linked from the footer: where times come from, the TMDB notice, how to ask for a removal. **Area links** (/area/lekki) open Cinemas with that area already chosen, for sharing.

What is on each screen, and where it leads

SCREEN	WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT YOU CAN DO	LEADS TO
Cinemas `home`	Your area, shown on the page. Cinema cards, nearest first: name, area, how many films today, the next start time.	Change your area. Pick a cinema. Search for a film or cinema.	Cinema page
Cinema page	The cinema's name, address and website. Day tabs. Its films as poster cards in a grid, each with that day's times.	Switch day. Tap a time. Tap a poster for the film. Open the cinema in maps.	One showing · Film page
Films	Every film showing in Lagos as a poster grid, with a search box and format chips (IMAX, 3D, 4D).	Type to narrow the list. Choose a format. Tap a film.	Film page
Film page	Poster, runtime, rating. Stay or Go: is there a scene after the credits, and who says so. Cinemas showing it, your area first, with times. Day tabs.	Switch day. Filter by format and area. Tap a time. Tap a cinema's name.	One showing · Cinema page
Starting soon	Poster cards for showings in the next 2 hours near you, each with its countdown; then later tonight.	Tap a card.	One showing
One showing `panel`	Film, cinema, day and time. "Starts in 45 min". Where the time came from and how fresh it is.	Book. Remind me. Share. Close.	The cinema's site · calendar · WhatsApp
About	How times are collected, each source and its status, the TMDB notice, how to ask for a removal, privacy.	Read. Follow a source link.	Outside links

Notices that can appear on any screen

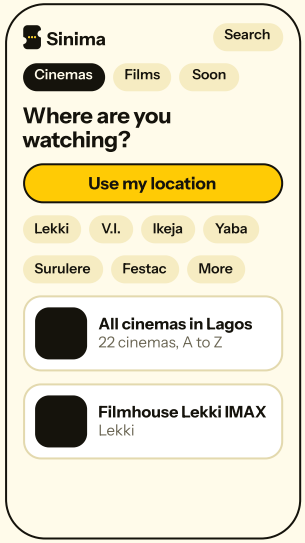
"Sample data" while the site runs on saved pages. "Some times were read yesterday" when a source is a day old. "You're offline" with the age of the saved times. One notice at a time, the most serious one.

Not in this structure

Accounts, ticket sales, seat maps, ads, push notifications. A week view: most cinemas publish only today and tomorrow, so the day tabs show as many days as the data holds.

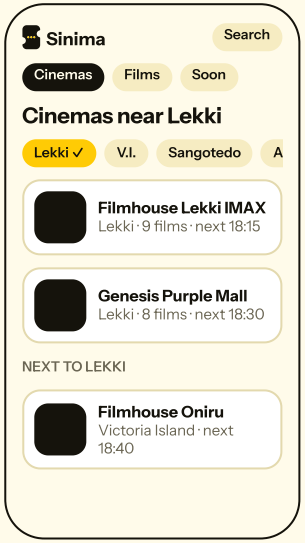
Your area lives on the page, not in a dropdown

The area decides the order of everything: cinemas, films' cinema lists and Starting soon all put your area first, then the areas next to it, then the rest of Lagos. It is a sentence on the page with chips beside it, always visible, changed with one tap.



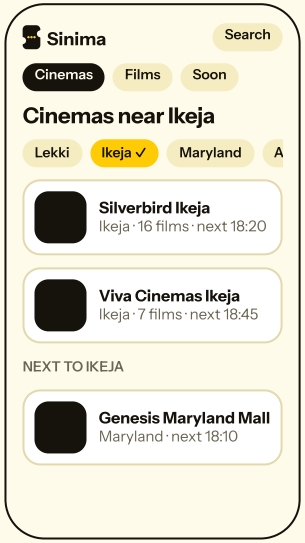
First visit

No area yet. All of Lagos is listed, with the question on top. Nothing blocks the page.



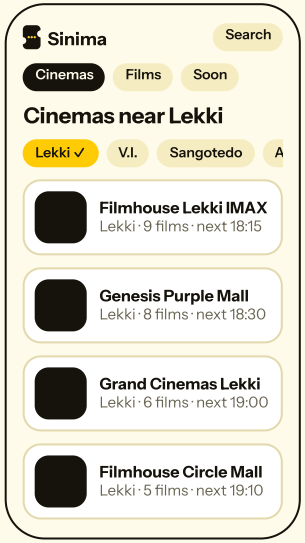
After you choose

Your area's cinemas come first, then the neighbouring areas, labelled. The chip shows what is set.



Changing it

Tap another chip. The list reorders in place. No sheet, no page of options.



Next time you open it

Sinima remembers the area on your phone and opens with it set. Nothing is sent anywhere.

"Nearest" means area, for now

We know each cinema's area, not its exact position on a map. So the order is: your area, the areas next to it, then the rest. No distances or travel times are shown, because we could not stand behind them.

Use my location

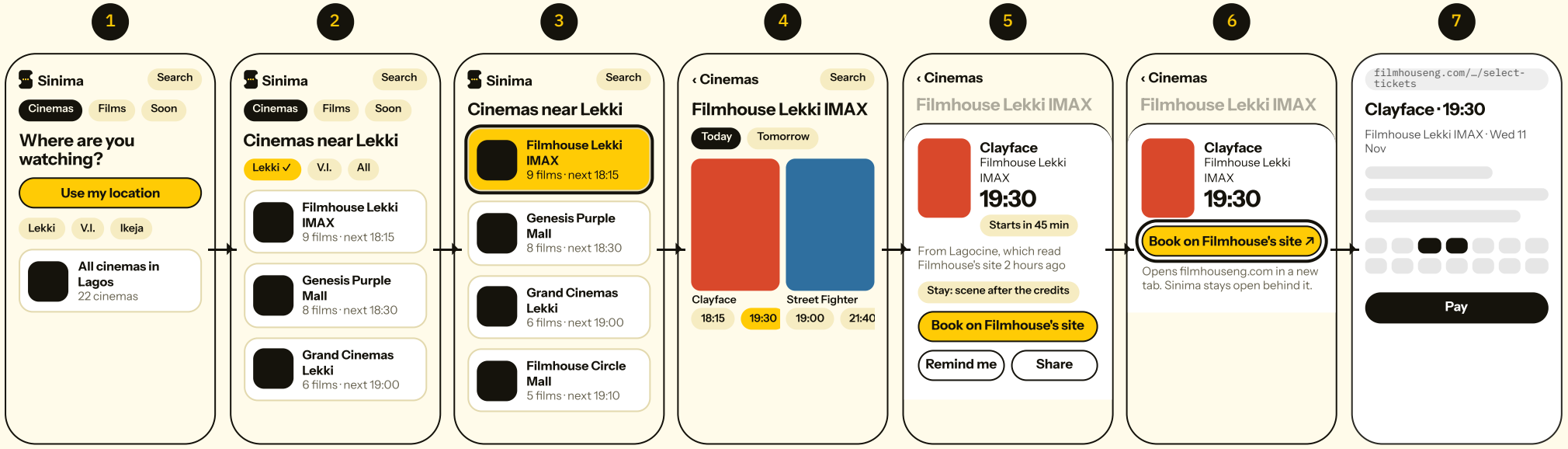
Only when you tap it. The phone works out the closest area and Sinima keeps just that area's name. If you say no: "No problem. Pick your area."

On desktop

The same chips sit in a row under the header. The cinema cards and posters form a grid of several per row instead of a single column.

From opening Sinima to booking at the cinema

Amaka is in Lekki after work and wants to see a film tonight. Seven steps, about a minute.



Opens Sinima

From a link, a search, or the icon on her home screen.

Sets her area

Taps Lekki. Next time it is already set.

Picks a cinema

Her usual one is at the top because it is in her area.

Browses the films

Posters with tonight's times. Taps 19:30 under Clayface.

Checks the showing

Time, countdown, how fresh the time is, and whether to stay for the credits.

Taps Book

The button names the site it opens, so there is no surprise.

Books at the cinema

Lands on that exact showing on the cinema's site. Seats and payment happen there.

Sinima's job ends at step 6. We never sell a ticket, take payment or add anything to the link. If the showing has already started, there is no Book button at all: it reads "Started 5 min ago".

Four taps on a first visit

Area, cinema, time, Book. Then she is on the cinema's site.

Three taps after that

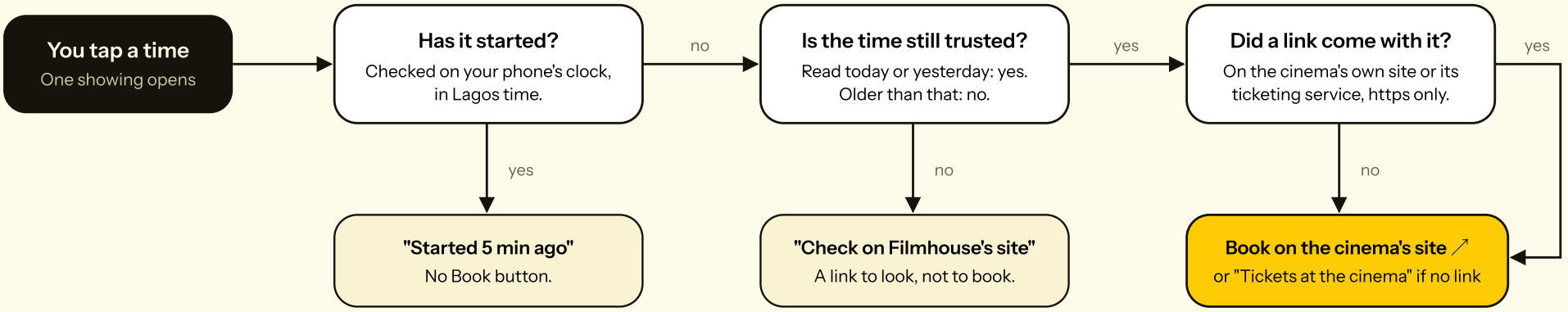
Her area is remembered, so she opens straight onto the cinemas near Lekki.

Nothing to sign up for

No account, no email, no app to install. The area is kept on her phone only.

Where Book takes you, case by case

"Directed to the correct cinema site" depends on what each cinema publishes. Sinima only ever uses the link that came with the showing, checked to be on that cinema's own site or the ticketing service it uses.



CINEMAS	WHERE BOOK LANDS	WHAT WE KNOW TODAY
Filmhouse · 7 cinemas	That exact showing's ticket page on filmhouseng.com	A link per showing in the saved data
Genesis · 3 cinemas	That showing's "book now" page on genesiscinemas.com	A link per showing in the saved data
EbonyLife · 1 cinema	That showing on ebonylifecinemas.com	A link per showing in the saved data
Silverbird Ikeja	That showing on Veezi, the ticketing service Silverbird uses	A link per showing in the saved data
Blue Pictures, Filmworld, Grand, Magnificent, Ozone, Sky, THC, Viva · 8 cinemas	No online booking found. The panel says "Tickets at the cinema" and shows the address.	No booking page listed for any of them

Counted from the Lagos listing saved on 11 Nov 2026: 207 of 353 showings carried a booking link. While the site runs on that saved sample, every button reads "Sample only" and nothing can be booked.

Three more journeys, same ending

B · I know the film

"Where is Clayface showing?"

Tunde has a film in mind and will go wherever suits.

Films tab
Poster grid of everything showing

Types "clay"
The grid narrows as he types

Film page
Cinemas showing it, his area first

Taps a time
One showing opens

Book
That cinema's own site

C · I'm free now

"What can I catch?"

Chime is leaving work and wants whatever starts next nearby.

Starting soon tab
Next 2 hours in his area

Scans the cards
Poster, time, "Starts in 25 min"

Nothing soon?
The areas next door, with counts

Taps a card
One showing opens

Book
That cinema's own site

D · A friend sent a link

"Coming to this one?"

Ngozi gets a WhatsApp message and has never opened Sinima.

Taps the link
"Clayface · Filmhouse Lekki · Wed 19:30"

Lands on the showing
The panel is open on the cinema's page

Remind me
Adds it to her calendar, alert 30 min before

Or Book
Same button, same rules

Closes the panel
She is on the cinema page and can look around

The film has started

"Started 5 min ago", no Book. It leaves Starting soon straight away.

The times are a day old

The showing says "read yesterday · check with the cinema". Book still works.

Nothing showing today

The cinema page opens on the next day that has films, and says so.

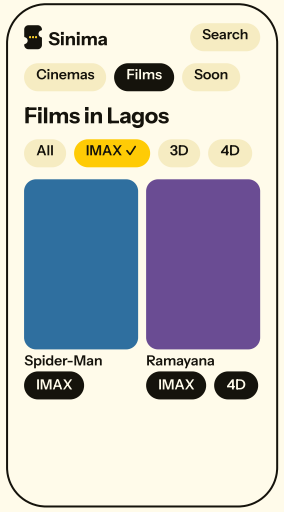
A cinema we don't cover

It is listed as "Times not available yet" with its website, never left out silently.

"Where is Spider-Man showing in IMAX?"

A fifth journey, added at your request. Pick a film, choose a format and an area, and see only the cinemas that match. Formats are IMAX, 3D and 4D (moving seats, sold in Lagos as MX4D); 2D is the standard.

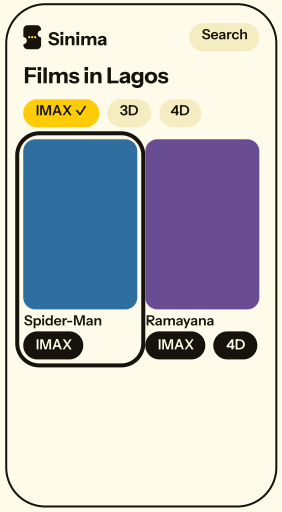
1



Chooses a format

Format chips sit on the Films tab. Only films showing in IMAX stay.

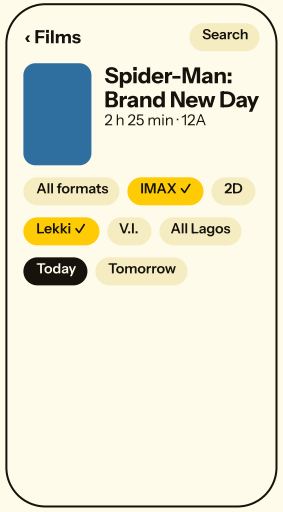
2



Picks the film

Each poster carries small tags for the formats it is showing in.

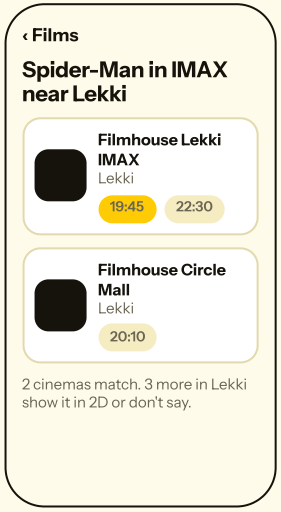
3



Format and area

On the film's page the same chips are set, with area and day beside them.

4



Only matching cinemas

The list shrinks to the cinemas showing it that way, and says what it left out.

5



Taps a time, then Book

The same panel as every other journey, with the format shown.

What the data can and can't say today

In the Lagos listing saved on 11 Nov, only the 7 Filmhouse cinemas say the format of each showing (IMAX at Lekki IMAX and Circle Mall, MX4D at Landmark). The other 13 cinemas give no format at all. With a format chosen they are left out and counted: "13 cinemas don't say their format". We never guess one.

Where the format shows

A tag on poster cards, on each time, in the showing panel and on the share card. On the Cinemas tab, a cinema shows the formats it has ("IMAX · 4D") and the same chips filter the list.

Films not out yet

Cinemas publish about two days ahead, so a film can be found once it has a showing. A "coming soon" list is not in this structure; say if you want it added.

Six decisions, approved on 12 November

You approved all six. They are kept here as the record. New in this draft: the format journey on the page before this one.

1

Home is Cinemas

Opening Sinima shows cinemas, nearest your area first. Films and Starting soon are the other two tabs. **My recommendation: yes.**

2

Area as chips on the page

Your area is always visible and changes with one tap. No dropdown and no sheet. "Use my location" is offered once, at the top.

3

A time opens a panel, not the cinema's site

Tapping a time shows the showing first (freshness, countdown, Remind me, Share), with Book as the main button. The other option is for a time to open the cinema's site at once, which is one tap shorter but skips all of that.

4

Days, not weeks

Day tabs show as many days as each cinema has published, usually today and tomorrow. A week view would be mostly empty.

5

Starting soon becomes a tab

It was the whole home page and the app's one-line pitch. Here it is one of three ways in. If you would rather it stayed on the home page as a strip above the cinemas, say so.

6

Cinemas we can't read are still listed

Silverbird Galleria and Leisure Mall have no times in our source. They appear as "Times not available yet" with a link to their own site.

After your yes

A reference board for the new structure, a font page with free fonts close to the one on cofounder.co, and Danfo applied to real screens.

Then

Full designs of each screen, desktop and phone side by side, for you to pick from. Nothing is built until you say "go with it".

About this document

The small screens are diagrams of structure, not designs. The colours are Danfo, as a first test. The font is a stand-in.